

COURSE NUMBER: CM1401

COURSE TITLE: Technical Report Writing II

COURSE DESCRIPTION:

This course is designed to help students formulate criteria for structuring informal and semi-formal reports. Various report formats will be examined with emphasis on statistical data analysis, documentation and illustration methods. Oral reporting techniques will be enhanced through problem-solving reports and the technical sales presentation.

PREREQUISITES: CM1400 – Technical Report Writing I

CO-REQUISITES: None

CARNEGIE UNIT: Three (3)

CREDIT VALUE: Three (3)

COURSE HOURS PER WEEK: Three (3)

LAB HOURS PER WEEK: Zero (0)

REQUIRED TEXT:

Lannon, J. M., Gurak, L. J., Klepp, D., Kelly, S. (2021). *Technical communication*. (9th Canadian edition). Pearson. eText ISBN: 9780137967742

LEARNING RESOURCES:

Perrin, R. (2021). *Pocket guide to APA Style with APA 7e Updates*. (7th Edition). Cengage Learning. ISBN: 9780357633021 eText ISBN: 9780357633021

MAJOR TOPICS:

- 1.0 The Strategy of Technical Reporting
- 2.0 Informal Reporting
- 3.0 Semi-Formal Reporting
- 4.0 Reporting Technical Information Orally
- 5.0 Keeping Accurate Work Records, Field Books and Log Books
- 6.0 Job Search

LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

1.0 The Strategy of Technical Reporting

- 1.1 Identify the Primary Reader
 - 1.1.1 Discuss how Audience Analysis is fundamental for the organization of a report
 - 1.1.2 Explain how to write for specific audiences
- 1.2 Identify the Main Message
 - 1.2.1 Differentiate between writing to inform and writing to persuade
 - 1.2.2 Describe how to structure the main message

2.0 Informal Reporting

- 2.1 Define memorandum report
- 2.2 Define a letter report
- 2.3 Discuss contexts where a memorandum report is appropriate
- 2.4 Discuss contexts where a letter report is appropriate
- 2.5 Write a memorandum report or letter report responding to a given topic or incident

3.0 Semi-Formal Reporting

- 3.1 Differentiate between industrial reports and school reports
- 3.2 Discuss the special features of semi-formal reports
- 3.3 Explain the methods for organizing the content sections of a semi-formal report including:
 - 3.3.1 Chronological development
 - 3.3.2 Subject development
 - 3.3.3 Concept development
- 3.4 Develop audience-appropriate content for a semi-formal report
- 3.5 Distinguish between progress and periodic reports
 - 3.5.1 Analyze context for utilization of progress and periodic reports
- 3.6 Discuss report elements
- 3.7 Examine sample reports including:
 - 3.7.1 Investigation
 - 3.7.2 Feasibility
 - 3.7.3 Evaluation
- 3.8 Explain the function of an appendix section
- 3.9 Discuss the elements of a technical report including:
 - 3.9.1 Observations
 - 3.9.2 Testing
 - 3.9.3 Interviewing
 - 3.9.4 Printed material

- 3.10 Select a topic for one of the following reports:
 - 3.10.1 Progress
 - 3.10.2 Investigation/Problem-solving
 - 3.10.3 Feasibility study
 - 3.10.4 Evaluation
- 3.11 Discuss the process of gathering and organizing data
 - 3.11.1 Develop a tentative list of materials including (but not limited to):
 - 3.11.1.1 Books
 - 3.11.1.2 Articles
 - 3.11.1.3 Government documents
 - 3.11.1.4 Valid Websites
 - 3.11.2 Record relevant material
 - 3.11.3 Construct a tentative outline
 - 3.11.4 Record specific quotes and analyses
 - 3.11.5 Expand the outline
 - 3.11.6 Begin the body of the report
- 3.12 Discuss the American Psychological Association (APA) style of documentation
- 3.13 Implement APA style of documentation
- 3.14 Write a draft of a semi-formal report
 - 3.14.1 Edit a draft of a semi-formal report
- 3.15 Explain how illustrations enhance technical information
 - 3.15.1 Give examples of illustrations used in sample semi-formal reports
 - 3.15.2 Explain how to organize and label illustrations
 - 3.15.3 Insert illustrations in the semi-formal report
- 3.16 Define letters of transmittal
- 3.17 Discuss elements of letters of transmittal including:
 - 3.17.1 Length
 - 3.17.2 Content
 - 3.17.3 Style
 - 3.17.4 Signature
 - 3.17.5 Context
- 3.18 Construct a letter of transmittal for the semi-formal report

4.0 Reporting Technical Information Orally

- 4.1 Define problem-solving report
- 4.2 Discuss program-specific situations for
 - 4.2.1 Problem-solving reports
 - 4.2.2 Technical persuasive presentations

- 4.3 Distinguish between emotional appeal and scientific argument
- 4.4 Select a program-specific topic for a problem-solving report
- 4.5 Develop presentation components including:
 - 4.5.1 An outline
 - 4.5.2 Speaker's notes
 - 4.5.3 Audio/visual graphics
- 4.6 Discuss delivery techniques for reporting technical information
- 4.7 Deliver orally a problem-solving report
- 4.8 Deliver orally a technical persuasive report

5.0 Keeping Accurate Work Records, Field Books and Log Books

- 5.1 Discuss the function of work records, field books and log books
- 5.2 Examine elements of work records, field books and log books including:
 - 5.2.1 Quality control
 - 5.2.2 Improvement
 - 5.2.3 Task tracking and scheduling
 - 5.2.4 Capturing institutional knowledge
 - 5.2.5 Maintaining institutional knowledge
 - 5.2.6 Privacy

6.0 Job Search

- 6.1 Distinguish between a cover letter and a resume
- 6.2 Assess tone and style in business writing
- 6.3 Research company profiles
- 6.4 Examine the organizational structure of sample cover letters
 - 6.4.1 Construct an effective cover letter
- 6.5 Analyze resume formats
 - 6.5.1 Prepare a cover letter and resume in response to a given program-related job advertisement
- 6.6 Describe types of interviews
 - 6.6.1 Assess the attributes of a successful interviewee including:
 - 6.6.1.1 Dress
 - 6.6.1.2 Body language
 - 6.6.1.3 Formality of speech
 - 6.6.1.4 Promptness
 - 6.6.1.5 Greetings
 - 6.6.1.6 Etiquette
 - 6.6.1.7 Interview kit
 - 6.6.1.8 Follow-up correspondence
 - 6.6.2 Evaluate questions from a given list that are commonly asked by an

interviewer
6.6.3 Prepare sample interview questions and answers for a selected program-related position

6.7 Discuss follow-up etiquette

EVALUATION:

Informal Report:	20%
Semi-Formal Report:	25%
Problem-Solving Report Presentation:	15%
Technical Persuasive Presentation:	15%
Job Search:	25%

DATE DEVELOPED: June 15, 1994

DATE REVIEWED: February 2018

REVISION NUMBER: 7

DATE REVISED: September 2023

Effective PeopleSoft Date: September 2024

Note to instructor: Check PIRS to ensure this outline is the most current version.